



Reading: Course 2 overview

Hello, and welcome to the second course of the Google Data Analytics Certificate program. You're on an exciting journey!

In this part of the program, you'll learn how data analysts use structured thinking to solve business problems. Then, you'll explore how to ask effective questions and use the answers to tell a meaningful story about data. Finally, you'll discover strategies for effectively communicating and collaborating with your stakeholders when defining a problem and presenting data insights. This will enable you to support and advance business goals with data!



Course Overview

1. **Foundations: Data, Data, Everywhere**
2. **Ask Questions to Make Data-Driven Decisions** (this course)
3. **Prepare Data for Exploration**
4. **Process Data from Dirty to Clean**
5. **Analyze Data to Answer Questions**
6. **Share Data Through the Art of Visualization**
7. **Introduction to Data Analysis Using Python**
8. **Google Data Analytics Capstone: Complete a Case Study**
9. **Accelerate Your Job Search with AI**

Course 2 content

Each course is broken into modules. Here's a quick overview of the skills you'll gain in each of the four Course 2 modules.

Module 1: Ask effective questions

Data analysts are constantly asking questions in order to find solutions and identify business potential. In this part of the course, you'll learn about effective questioning techniques that will help guide your analysis.

Module 2: Make data-driven decisions

In analytics, data drives decision-making, and this is your opportunity to explore data of all kinds and its impact on all sorts of business decisions. You'll also learn how to effectively share your data through reports and dashboards.

Module 3: Spreadsheet magic

Spreadsheets are a key data analytics tool. Here you'll learn both why and how data analysts use spreadsheets in their work. You'll also investigate how structured thinking helps analysts understand problems and come up with solutions.

Module 4: Always remember the stakeholder

Successful data analysts balance the needs and expectations of their team and the stakeholders they support. In this part of the course, you'll learn strategies for managing stakeholder expectations while establishing clear communication with your team.

What to expect

Each course offers many types of learning opportunities:

- **Videos** for instructors to teach new concepts and demonstrate the use of tools
- **Step-by-step guides** you can use to follow along with instructors as they demonstrate tools
- **Readings** to explore topics more in-depth and build on the concepts from the videos
- **Practice quizzes** to prepare you for graded quizzes
- **Graded quizzes** to measure your progress and give you valuable feedback

This program was designed to let you work at your own pace—your personalized deadlines are just a guide. There is no penalty for late assignments. To earn your certificate, you simply need to complete all of the work.

In this course, you'll be assessed with graded quizzes and activities. Both are based on the wide variety of learning materials and activities that reinforce the important skills you'll develop. And both can be taken more than once.

Tips for success

- It is strongly recommended that you go through the items in each lesson in the order they appear because new information and concepts build on previous knowledge.
- Participate in all learning opportunities to gain as much knowledge and experience as possible.
- If something is confusing, don't hesitate to replay a video, review a reading, or repeat a self-review activity.
- When you encounter useful links in this course, bookmark them so you can refer to the information later for study or review.

Congratulations on choosing to become part of the wonderful world of data analytics!
